chuzos



INVESTOR Q&A · PREGUNTAS Y RESPUESTAS PARA INVERSORES

Chuzos
Investor Q&A

Online ordering for the informal food stalls that big delivery apps leave out — Colombia & Mexico.

Pedidos en línea para los puestos de comida informales que las grandes apps dejan por fuera.

Paying customer: the stall | Prepaid flat fee per order | Pilot: Bogotá, Chapinero | Seeking a co-founder

Status, October 2026: working offline prototype · app screens designed, not built · **no revenue yet** · no government partnership · solo founder seeking a co-founder. Figures marked ESTIMATE are planning assumptions.

ONE-PAGE SUMMARY

Chuzos on one page

Chuzos en una página

Chuzos lets informal food stalls in Colombia and Mexico take orders from customers' phones — without needing a tax ID first. Consumers use it free; stalls prepay a flat COP 1,000 (MXN 5) per order.

Chuzos permite a los puestos de comida informales recibir pedidos por celular, sin exigir RUT/RFC. El consumidor no paga; el puesto prepaga COP 1.000 por pedido.

Problem

Millions of street and neighbourhood food sellers take orders by WhatsApp: no discovery, no order queue, no status. Big delivery apps are built for formal restaurants (tax registration, % commissions).

Paying customer

The stall (merchant). Chuzos (skewers), arepas, empanadas, home-cooked lunches. Phone + WhatsApp; RUT/RFC optional. **Consumers use the app free.**

Business model

Prepaid credits. Min. top-up **COP 20,000**. **COP 1,000 / MXN 5** per order, refunded if rejected or cancelled before acceptance. **5 free orders** to start.

Where we are

Working **offline prototype**: order flow, matching, prepaid wallet; all automated tests passing. App screens designed, **not built yet**. **No revenue, no users yet.**

Pilot

Bogotá, Chapinero (Calle 45–60 × Carrera 7–13), 90 days. Go if **≥40%** of stalls top up after their free orders.

The ask

A co-founder first (partnerships & city go-to-market). Pilot budget ESTIMATE: lean **≈ USD 8,500** / standard **≈ USD 21,000**.

Legal by design
Customer pays the stall directly · Chuzos never touches food money · no Chuzos courier fleet · credits only pay Chuzos fees · every top-up invoiced with VAT.

What we do not claim
No revenue · no signed stalls or LOIs · no government partnership (policy-aligned only) · no "zero risk". Estimates are labelled.

Key numbers · Cifras clave

COP 1,000
flat fee per order (MXN 5 in Mexico), from prepaid credits

COP 20,000
minimum top-up · 5 free welcome orders

90 days
pilot in one Chapinero corridor · 30 stalls onboarded ESTIMATE

≥ 40%
of stalls topping up after free orders = go decision

How an order and the money flow work: page 3. Legal design: Q13. Budget: Q16.

HOW CHUZOS WORKS

An order, step by step

Cómo funciona un pedido

1 · Customer orders

Scans the stall's QR or opens its link, picks food and chooses **pickup** or **stall delivery**. Free for the customer.

2 · Fee is reserved

When the order is placed, **COP 1,000** (MXN 5) is debited from the stall's prepaid credits. No credits → no order.

3 · Stall decides

Accepts: fee is earned. **Rejects**, or the order is cancelled before acceptance: fee is **refunded automatically**.

4 · Handoff & payment

Stall delivers with its own people (≈1 km ESTIMATE) or the customer picks up with a code. **Customer pays the stall** in cash or by transfer.

Prepaid credits at a glance · Créditos prepago

COP 20,000
minimum top-up (= 20 orders). Small packs keep fees reasonable.

COP 1,000
flat fee per order in Colombia · **MXN 5** in Mexico. No % commission, no monthly fee.

5 free
welcome orders for every new stall (COP 5,000 / MXN 25).

0%
receivables on our fees: we are paid before the order runs.

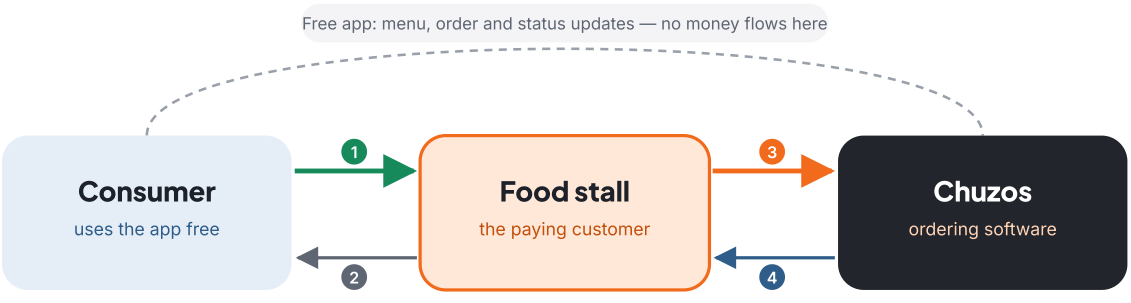
Credits are not money

They only pay Chuzos fees. **Not transferable, not withdrawable, and they expire.** When credits run out or expire, the stall stops receiving orders until it tops up — no debt, no collections.

How stalls top up

Preferred: direct transfer to Chuzos' account (Nequi, Daviplata or Bre-B) with a reference code — no gateway fees. **Secondary:** a licensed gateway such as Wompi. Each top-up gets an electronic invoice with VAT.

Who pays whom · Flujo del dinero



1 · Pays for the food
cash or direct transfer to the stall

2 · Food
stall delivers or pickup

3 · Buys prepaid credits
min. COP 20,000 · direct transfer w/ reference (Nequi / Daviplata / Bre-B) or licensed gateway

4 · Credits + e-invoice with VAT
COP 1,000 / MXN 5 debited per order

Chuzos never receives food money

No Chuzos courier fleet in the pilot

Why this design matters: because Chuzos never collects the food payment and runs no courier fleet, it stays outside the riskiest rules for platforms in Colombia and Mexico (courier social security, Mexican platform tax withholding, e-money licensing). Counsel in each country must still confirm — see Legal, Q13.

SECTION 1

Market & customer

Mercado y cliente

Q1 Who is your target customer?

The informal food stall — and it is the only side that pays.

- **Who:** small prepared-food sellers — chuzos (skewers), arepas, empanadas, home-cooked lunches, fried snacks, juices. Fixed or semi-fixed spot, stable hours.
- **Profile:** owner or relative has an Android phone with WhatsApp; often already gets orders by chat. **No RUT (CO) / RFC (MX) is fine** — that is precisely the segment big apps leave out.
- **Ticket:** about COP 8,000–25,000 ESTIMATE, so the COP 1,000 fee is roughly 4–12% of a ticket.
- **Consumers** (students, office workers nearby) use the app **free**. They are users, not customers.

Q2 How big is the opportunity?

Very large — we cite official counts, not an invented TAM.

5.3M
micro-businesses in Colombia; 90.2% multidimensional business informality (DANE EMICRON & IMIE 2024)

25.4%
of Mexico's GDP is informal economy; 54.4% of workers are informal (INEGI MEI 2024)

#1
prepared food is the top product among Bogotá's registered informal vendors (17.62%, IPES Dec-2024)

Not all of these are food stalls, and none is our addressable market yet. We will size the real market from pilot data.

Q3 How many real stalls said yes? FREQUENT OBJECTION

None signed yet — and we say so upfront.

No letters of intent, no live users, no revenue. What exists is a working offline prototype. The next step is not more demos: walk one corridor, map ~60 stalls, onboard **30** and get **20 active weekly** ESTIMATE — then measure whether they pay.

Q4 What is your beachhead? FREQUENT OBJECTION

One walkable corridor, not "the whole city".

Bogotá, Chapinero: Calle 45–60 × Carrera 7–13 — universities and offices (smartphone demand) plus documented street-food vending. Backup corridor: **Kennedy**, the locality with the 2nd-largest share of Bogotá's registered informal vendors (10.51%, IPES Dec-2025). **Mexico City** (public markets, tianguis) follows once Bogotá proves stalls pay.

SECTION 2

Product & MVP

Producto y MVP

Q5 What is actually built today?

The core logic works offline. The apps people will tap are designed but not built.

Status	What
Built & tested	Order state machine (13 states: draft → requested → accepted → … → delivered, plus reject / cancel) · matching engine · prepaid wallet with fee debit and refund · COP and MXN money handling · **all automated tests passing** · command-line demo. Runs fully offline.
Designed only	19 app screens (consumer, merchant, courier) in a visual design guide.
Not built yet	Hosted backend, the apps themselves, real top-up payments, credit expiry, notifications, electronic invoicing. Planned for pilot weeks 0–4 ESTIMATE.

Courier matching exists in code but stays **switched off** in the pilot: stalls deliver themselves or customers pick up.

Q6 A laptop demo is not a rainy street with bad GPS. FREQUENT OBJECTION

Agreed. The demo proves the rules, not the operations.

- The field will break things first: mobile signal, phone notifications, stalls not answering in rush hour.
- That is why the pilot is **one dense corridor, 90 days**, with a **WhatsApp fallback** — if the app fails, operations passes the order by hand and logs it.
- No live GPS routing needed: delivery within ~1 km ESTIMATE by the stall, or pickup with a 4-digit code.
- Stall doesn't answer in 5 minutes → order auto-cancels and the fee is refunded.

The open risk is **operations and adoption**, not whether the order logic exists.

From prototype to pilot · Del prototipo al piloto

Today

Offline core: orders, states, wallet, fee debit / refund, COP + MXN. Tests passing.

Weeks 0–4 ESTIMATE

Hosted backend, merchant app (alert, accept/reject, balance, top-up), consumer web app, top-up flow, e-invoicing. AI agents code; part-time CTO reviews security and payments.

Weeks 5–12

Live in Chapinero. Manual fallbacks allowed: top-ups credited by hand within the hour, menu edits by ops, metrics from SQL + a sheet.

SECTION 3

Business model & prepaid credits

Modelo de negocio y créditos prepago

Q7 What is your take rate? FREQUENT OBJECTION

No percentage commission and no monthly fee — a flat COP 1,000 per order (MXN 5 in Mexico).

- Paid from the stall's **prepaid credits**, debited when the order is placed.
- **Refunded** if the stall rejects the order or it is cancelled before acceptance. Once accepted, the fee is earned.
- Every new stall gets **5 free orders** (COP 5,000 / MXN 25) to try it.

Unit view: on a COP 8,000–25,000 ticket the fee is ~4–12% ESTIMATE. Working assumption: the price includes 19% VAT, so net revenue ≈ **COP 840 per order** TO VERIFY with our accountant. **No revenue yet** — the pilot tests whether stalls pay after the free five.

Q8 How does Chuzos receive money?

Only one way: stalls buying credits. Never the food money.

Preferred: direct transfer

Stall transfers to **Chuzos' own account** via Nequi, Daviplata or Bre-B with a reference code; credits are loaded once matched. Avoids gateway fees.

Secondary: licensed gateway

e.g. Wompi (card / PSE). On small top-ups fees bite: Wompi's Advanced plan is 2.65% + COP 700 + VAT — about 12% of a COP 10,000 top-up. Hence the **COP 20,000 minimum**.

Minimum top-up **COP 20,000** (20 orders). Chuzos issues an **electronic invoice with VAT** for every top-up.

Q9 Why prepaid instead of billing stalls later?

1 · Paid before we work. 0% receivables on our fees; we never chase thousands of small stalls for invoices.

2 · A familiar habit. Works like topping up mobile minutes from Nequi.

3 · Self-limiting. When credits run out or expire, orders pause until top-up. No debt, no collections.

4 · Out of the food money. Simpler legally and for tax (see Q13).

Trade-off we accept: stalls must commit cash upfront. The pilot is designed to test exactly that.

SECTION 3 · CONTINUED

Business model & prepaid credits

Modelo de negocio y créditos prepago

Q10 What if stalls don't top up?

Then the model doesn't work — and we will know fast and cheaply.

It is the pilot's main hypothesis, with thresholds set before launch ESTIMATE:

≥ 40%	20–39%	< 20%
Go — raise pre-seed, open a second corridor	**Iterate** 30–45 days: price, pack sizes, channels	**Stop or pivot** — market size won't save it

% of stalls that used their 5 free orders and then paid at least one top-up.

Before giving up we try: two-tap top-up from Nequi, small packs (COP 20k / 50k / 100k), an operations call when a balance hits zero, and interviews with stalls that did and didn't top up. A stall that doesn't top up simply stops receiving orders — it owes nothing.

Q11 Cash-first: who absorbs non-payment and disputes? FREQUENT OBJECTION

Food payment is between customer and stall. We don't carry that risk — and we don't hide it.

- Customer pays the stall in cash or by direct transfer; the app only shows the stall's Nequi/Daviplata number.
- **Tools we provide:** reject/cancel states with automatic fee refund, pickup code, ratings, no-show warnings and blocking of repeat offenders, WhatsApp support with human escalation.
- **Our own fee risk** is covered because credits are prepaid.

> ⚠ **Honest limit:** non-payment between a customer and a stall can still happen. We reduce it; we don't eliminate it. We have no plan to hold food money — any future in-app payment would go through a licensed partner.

When things go wrong · Qué pasa si algo falla

Situation	What happens
Stall doesn't answer within 5 minutes	Order auto-cancels; fee refunded; ops pings the stall on WhatsApp
Customer doesn't pick up	Fee stays (order was accepted); 2nd no-show → warning or block
Payment dispute ("the transfer didn't arrive")	Customer asked for proof; not Chuzos money; repeat → customer blocked
App goes down	WhatsApp fallback: ops passes the order by hand and logs it
Top-up not confirmed	No credits until payment is confirmed; if paid but not credited, fixed by hand the same day

SECTION 4

Competition: Rappi & WhatsApp

Competencia: Rappi y WhatsApp

Q12 Why don't you lose to Rappi or WhatsApp? FREQUENT OBJECTION

They serve different sellers. Rappi wins with formal merchants; WhatsApp wins on zero friction but gives zero discovery.

Chuzos adds **discovery + an order queue + order status** for stalls **without RUT/RFC on day one**, at a flat fee they can see. These are the same sellers governments already train and fund — Colombia's Ley 2470/2025 includes e-commerce and delivery training; Bogotá's IPES trains street vendors; CDMX rehabilitates public markets. We are **policy-aligned, not partnered**.

	Large delivery apps (e.g. Rappi)	WhatsApp	Chuzos
Built for	Formal restaurants and chains	Anyone	**Informal stalls; RUT/RFC optional**
Cost to the seller	Percentage commission per order	Free	**Flat COP 1,000 / MXN 5, prepaid**
New customers find you	Yes	No — only existing contacts	**Yes, in the local corridor**
Order queue & status	Yes	Manual chat	**Yes (accept / reject / ready / delivered)**
Delivery	Platform courier fleet	Seller arranges	**Stall delivers or customer picks up**
Handles food payment	Yes, in-app	No	**No — customer pays the stall**

Comparison is qualitative and based on our research; we don't quote competitors' specific commission rates.

"Rappi for stalls" without couriers? Deliberately, for now. iFood (Brazil) launched in 2011 with restaurants doing their own delivery (Valor, 2011). A Chuzos fleet would come later, only if fully compliant and priced in.

Real risk — leakage: a customer found on Chuzos may later order by WhatsApp directly. That is normal for marketplaces. Our value is **new** customers, and we measure new vs. repeat orders.

How others started small · Cómo empezaron otros

Rappi · 2015
~5 blocks of Bogotá; supply mapped by hand; donuts handed out for downloads (LAVCA, YC)

DoorDash · 2013
PDF menus + a phone number; 200+ merchant interviews first (TechCrunch, DoorDash)

iFood · 2011
Restaurants did their own delivery; 230 venues at launch (Valor)

Chowdeck · 2021
Two partner restaurants, two Lagos neighbourhoods before scaling (TechCrunch)

SECTION 5

Legal & regulation

Legal y regulación

Q13 Is this legal? Couriers, taxes, incorporation. FREQUENT OBJECTION

We designed the model around the three rules that could break it. Counsel in Colombia and Mexico confirms before launch.

Money

We never touch food money. Stalls prepay **service credits that only pay Chuzos fees** — not transferable, not withdrawable, they expire — designed so they are not e-money. Every top-up is invoiced with VAT.

Couriers — biggest risk

Colombia Ley 2466/2025 art. 27: platforms pay 60% of health & pension plus occupational-risk insurance for independent couriers (applies 12 months after the government regulates it). **Mexico** labour-law reform in force since 22 Jun 2025; IMSS pilot since 1 Jul 2025. **Our pilot has no Chuzos fleet.**

Mexico tax

SAT withholding applies to payments a platform handles: **20% income tax + 16% VAT** if the seller has no RFC. We don't collect order money, so there is nothing to withhold. Mexican tax counsel to confirm before CDMX.

Entity

Now: no entity needed; Colombian SAS for the pilot + founders' agreement. **Pre-seed:** Delaware C-Corp owning the SAS. **Expansion:** Mexican subsidiary. **Estonia OÜ: not recommended** — we are managed from Colombia.

Research, not legal advice. We never say "zero legal risk" or "government-approved". A full Spanish legal framework with sources is available as a separate document.

Q14 Do you have a government partnership? FREQUENT OBJECTION

No. Zero MoUs, zero agreements.

We are **policy-aligned**: we serve the same people as Colombia's *Economía Popular* programmes, Ley 2470/2025, Bogotá's IPES and Mexico City's SEDECO market programmes. If a public-plaza pilot happens later, we will sign it then — we don't sell it today.

Incorporation roadmap · Ruta de constitución

Now → pilot
No entity needed to apply. Colombian SAS when the pilot must invoice and contract; founders' agreement (equity, vesting, IP).

Pre-seed
Delaware C-Corp (e.g. Stripe Atlas, USD 500) owning 100% of the SAS; SAFEs. Colombian tax review of the structure.

Mexico expansion
Mexican subsidiary (S.A.P.I. de C.V.) after Mexican labour and tax counsel sign-off.

SECTION 6

Pilot & use of funds

Piloto y uso de fondos

Q15 Why Bogotá first?

Home market. The founder is Colombian and knows how these stalls work.

Density. Chapinero packs universities, offices and street food into a walkable corridor.

Data to choose stalls. Bogotá's IPES publishes registries of informal vendors by locality and product.

Legal sequencing. Mexico's platform-work and tax rules are stricter and already in force; we want Mexican counsel's sign-off first.

Mexico is already supported in the product (MXN pricing configured); CDMX follows once Bogotá shows stalls pay.

Q16 How much do you need, and for what?

≈ USD 8,500 for a lean 90-day pilot, or ≈ USD 21,000 to run it properly. ESTIMATE

≈ COP 34M

Lean ≈ USD 8,500. Founder runs operations; 1 part-time promoter; CTO 6 h/week; one month of paid digital.

≈ COP 84M

Standard ≈ USD 21,000. Full-time city ops lead, 2 promoters, CTO 10 h/week, paid digital weeks 5–12.

Budget line (COP millions)	Lean	Standard
City operations lead	—	13.5M
Field promoters	5.4M	7.2M
Part-time CTO	9.4M	20.8M
Marketing (QR, stickers, flyers, stands)	3.0M	8.0M
Paid digital (Meta, TikTok — geo-targeted)	1.5M	5.0M
Infrastructure (hosting, WhatsApp API, SMS)	1.2M	2.0M
AI agent tools	2.4M	2.4M
Gateway fees	0.2M	0.3M
Legal, SAS, accountant, e-invoicing	6.0M	12.0M
Field phone, transport, misc.	0.5M	2.0M
15% contingency	4.4M	11.0M
Total	**≈ 34.0M** (~USD 8.5k)	**≈ 84.2M** (~USD 21k)

All figures are planning estimates at COP 4,000 = USD 1, include 15% contingency and exclude founder salary. **Not spent on:** couriers or food subsidies. Pilot fee revenue ≈ COP 1.5M gross ESTIMATE — it proves willingness to pay, it does not fund the pilot.

SECTION 6 · CONTINUED

Pilot & use of funds

Piloto y uso de fondos

Q17 What happens in the 90 days, and what does success look like?

Weeks 0–4 · Build & prepare
Apps on the tested core, top-ups, SAS, terms, privacy policy, invoicing; map 60 stalls, onboard 30.

Weeks 5–12 · Live in Chapinero
Corridor launch, university stands, QR at stalls. Week 7+: first stalls run out of free orders — the moment of truth.

Week 13
Data report & decision

Option: prepare in Nov–Dec 2026 and go live the 2nd week of January 2027, when university classes resume.

30	20	600	~1,500
stalls onboarded ESTIMATE	stalls active weekly ESTIMATE	registered consumers ESTIMATE	orders, weeks 5–12 ESTIMATE

Day-90 KPI	Go	Iterate	Stop / pivot
Stalls that top up after free orders (main test)	≥ 40%	20–39%	< 20%
Second top-up (of those who topped up)	≥ 50%	25–49%	< 25%
Orders per active stall per week (weeks 9–12)	≥ 10	5–9	< 5
Consumers ordering again within 30 days	≥ 30%	15–29%	< 15%
Acquisition cost per active stall	≤ COP 150k	150–300k	> 300k
Human support tickets per order	≤ 0.15	0.15–0.3	> 0.3
Orders rejected by stalls	≤ 15%	15–25%	> 25%

Thresholds are our proposals to discuss with investors, not published benchmarks.

What an investor receives at day 90: cohort data (free orders used → 1st top-up → 2nd top-up), orders per stall, pickup vs. delivery, rejections, consumer repeat at 7 and 30 days by channel, acquisition cost, support load, 10 stall interviews, and an explicit go / iterate / stop decision.

SECTION 7

Team & co-founder

Equipo y co-founder

Q18 Who is on the team today?

A solo founder — and we treat that as a risk to fix first.

- **Founder (Colombian):** sales, stall relationships, product direction, field testing. Full time.
- **Engineering:** built with AI coding agents. For the pilot, a **part-time senior CTO** (6–10 h/week) reviews architecture, security and payments — a person investors can interview.
- **External:** lawyer and accountant, paid by the hour.
- **AI agents** handle first-line WhatsApp support, content and menu clean-up — always with a human approving.

Q19 What do you offer a co-founder? FREQUENT OBJECTION

Real equity and ownership of a city. Capital comes after the partner.

Who we are looking for

- Partnerships & city go-to-market (Bogotá first, CDMX later)
- Network with stalls, local government, universities, media
- Has closed **signed** partnerships before — not just "contacts"
- Comfortable on the street; Spanish + English
- Or: a product builder who can ship the apps

What we offer

- Meaningful equity, negotiated: reference range **25–45%** for someone joining after idea & prototype
- **4-year vesting, 1-year cliff** (standard)
- Title negotiable; salary once funded
- Context: two-founder median split is 51/49 (Carta)

Our honesty rules · Lo que nunca decimos

- No revenue or users claimed before they exist
- No invented letters of intent or MoUs
- No government partnership or "government-backed"
- No "zero legal risk"
- Official statistics only, with source; our estimates are labelled
- Counsel confirms legal points before launch

How you can help · Cómo puedes ayudar

Introductions

Co-founder candidates with a Bogotá or CDMX network; university and street-vendor community contacts; labour, fintech and tax counsel in Colombia and Mexico.

Pilot backing

Incubator support or pre-seed capital for the 90-day pilot (≈ USD 8,500 lean / ≈ USD 21,000 standard ESTIMATE), in exchange for a day-90 data report and a clear go / iterate / stop decision.

APPENDIX

Sources & glossary

Fuentes y glosario

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Glossary

Term	Meaning
Stall / puesto	Informal food seller; Chuzos' paying customer
Credits	Prepaid balance that only pays Chuzos fees
Top-up / recarga	Stall buys credits (min. COP 20,000)
RUT / RFC	Tax ID in Colombia / Mexico — optional on Chuzos
Nequi, Daviplata, Bre-B	Colombian mobile wallets and instant-transfer rail
Wompi	Licensed Colombian payment gateway
SAS	Colombian simplified stock company
IPES	Bogotá's public institute for the popular economy (street vendors)
SAT / DIAN	Tax authority of Mexico / Colombia
IMSS	Mexican Social Security Institute
Tianguis	Traditional street markets in Mexico
ESTIMATE	Our planning assumption, to be validated in the pilot
TO VERIFY	To be confirmed by an accountant or counsel

⚠ Prepared October 2026. Legal statements are research, not legal advice. Exchange rate for planning: COP 4,000 = USD 1.